

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

What makes an excellent résumé?



Learning Outcome

Identify and describe jobs and careers in both work and social contexts appropriate for the interlocutor.

Ask your partner:

- Why do you think résumés are important?
- What are the qualities of a great résumé?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about events and experiences related to a job.
- I can talk about general issues related to a job search.
- I can explain why résumés are important.

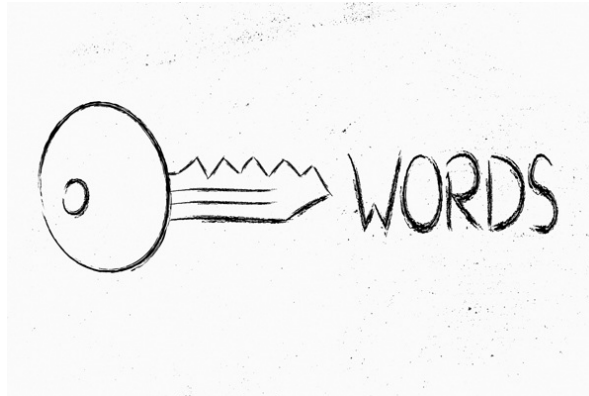




Let's Explore!

Kristi and Bianca discuss the **merits*** of a good résumé.

* "Merits" is another word for advantages.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Kristi:** So, I'm beginning to realize how important a great résumé is. It should be worked on carefully and thoughtfully.
- Bianca:** Of course. A great deal of time must be put into writing a résumé. All of the important facts must be clearly and succinctly spelled out to potential employers.
- Kristi:** But why do we need a résumé? We could just go in for an interview.
- Bianca:** The purpose of a résumé is to provide a summary of your skills, abilities and accomplishments. It can show how to fit into your target industry.
- Kristi:** Yeah, and that's really important because the potential employer wants to know what value you will bring to the company. You need statements that are vivid and that clearly spotlight what you bring to the table over anyone else.
- Bianca:** I heard that résumés are read over by employers for only seven seconds. They're not reading, they're skimming. So you need to make it clear right off the bat how you can add value.
- Kristi:** Your résumé is often the first point of contact and it needs to be easy to read. It's expedient if your experience, strengths, and selling points are laid out in brief, bulleted sentences.
- Bianca:** Did you know that résumés are now looked over by computers?
- Kristi:** What do you mean?
- Bianca:** Résumés are fed into a scanner that looks for keywords that the employer is looking for. If the résumé doesn't contain enough of the right keywords, the résumé is thrown out before a person ever looks at it.
- Kristi:** So how do I know what keywords I need?
- Bianca:** Maybe you'll find out in the résumé workshop.





Let's Practice!

Kristi describes what is necessary in a résumé. What does she say?

Instructions: Read the sentences. Circle the correct option to correctly complete each sentence.

- 1) It should **be worked on / been worked on** carefully and thoughtfully.
- 2) A great deal of time **must put / must be put** into writing a résumé.
- 3) All of the important facts must be clearly and succinctly **spelled out / spell out -** to potential employers.
- 4) I heard that résumés **are read over / be read over** by employers for only seven seconds.
- 5) Did you know that résumés **are now looked over / is now looked** over by computers?



Let's Practice!

What are some words that Kristi uses to describe a résumé?

Instructions: Read the definitions. Write the correct word. Complete the wordsearch correctly.

- 1) _____, said in a clear and short way.
- 2) _____, to draw attention to something specific.
- 3) _____, clear and detailed.
- 4) _____, to explain very explicitly.
- 5) _____, a word of high importance.
- 6) _____, helpful or useful.

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Y	T	Q	O	U	T	U	O	L	L	E	P	S	T	P
M	H	Y	Y	N	V	N	S	G	Z	U	U	P	I	E
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Q	P	G	G	R	E	S	I	I	V	E	L	Y	K	B
C	S	A	H	C	R	Y	D	S	E	I	R	V	T	Q
D	O	N	I	N	T	E	R	A	C	T	M	Q	G	C
S	T	A	F	S	R	Z	S	D	R	O	W	Y	E	K



Extension Activity

Research résumé styles.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- On the Internet, research different styles and designs for résumés.
- Find one example of a résumé style that you like and one example of a résumé style you don't like.
- Compare the two résumés and make notes on what you like and dislike about them and why.
- Present your opinions to your class or group.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I research résumé styles on the Internet.

☐
☐

I compare a résumé style I like to a résumé style I dislike.

☐
☐

I summarize my opinions and reasons.

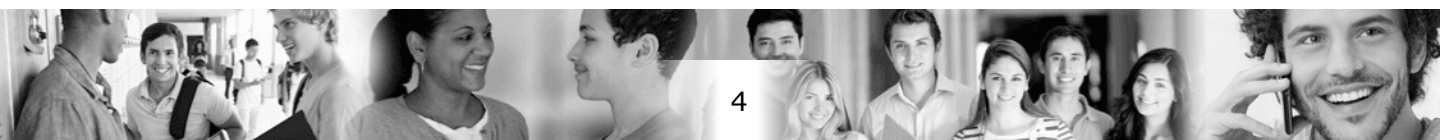
☐
☐

I present my opinions and reasons to a group.

☐
☐


Target Words

- to bring to the table** (expression): to provide something of benefit
e.g. You need statements that are vivid and that clearly spotlight what you bring to the table over anyone else.
- succinctly** (adverb): said in a clear and short way
e.g. You should explain your ideas succinctly.
- vivid** (adjective): clear and detailed
e.g. The story he told was vivid.
- to spotlight** (verb): to draw attention to something specific
Example: Your résumé should spotlight your strengths.
- to skim** (verb): to read something quickly and look for the main ideas
e.g. They're not reading, they're skimming.
- right off the bat** (expression): from the start; immediately
Example: You need to make it clear right off the bat.
- spell out** (verb): to explain very explicitly
e.g. All of the important facts must be clearly and succinctly spelled out to potential employers.
- expedient** (adjective): helpful or useful
e.g. It's expedient if your experience, strengths, and selling points are laid out briefly.
- bulleted** (adjective): in list format
e.g. A bulleted list is clear and easy to read.
- keyword** (noun): a word of high importance
e.g. Résumés are fed into a scanner that looks for keywords.





Learning Points

The Simple Present Passive with phrasal verbs

You use an active structure when you want the 'doer' of the action to be the subject.
You use a passive structure when you want the 'receiver' of the action to be the subject.
Phrasal verbs are often used in the passive voice.

In an **active** sentence, the subject of the sentence does the action.

In a **passive** sentence, the subject of the sentence receives the action. Something is done to the subject. The majority of the sentences you see are active.

[Thing doing action] + [verb] + [thing receiving action]

For example:

Active sentence = *Employers (subject) **read over** résumés.(object)*

In a **passive** sentence, the object of the active sentence has moved to the subject position. This indicates that it is receiving, rather than doing the action. When the person/thing doing the action is important to the understanding of the sentence, it is included using a 'by' phrase.

The **passive** form is used to highlight the person/thing that is receiving the action. It is considered to be more formal or impersonal.

The **passive** form is also used when the 'doer' is unknown or unimportant.

[Thing receiving action] + [be] + [past participle of verb] + [by] + [thing doing action]

For example:

Passive sentence = *Résumés (subject) **are read over.** (by employers)*

It is not necessary to mention the object in a passive sentence.

It is common for **phrasal verbs** to be used in the passive voice. The past participle of the phrasal verb is used and the particle stays the same.

For example:

*The résumé is **thrown out** before a person ever looks at it.*

*It should be **worked on** carefully and thoughtfully.*

Examples:

- *It should be worked on carefully and thoughtfully.*
- *A great deal of time must be put into writing a résumé.*
- *All of the important facts must be clearly and succinctly spelled out to potential employers.*
- *I heard that résumés are read over by employers for only seven seconds.*
- *It's expedient if your experience, strengths, and selling points are laid out in brief, bulleted*





Learning Points

sentences.

- *Did you know that résumés are now looked over by computers?*

Elements of a great résumé

A great résumé is crucial to your job search. There are some elements that must be included in every résumé.

1. ORGANIZED FORMAT

Your résumé should be well-organized; the font should be plain - Arial or Verdana, for example. The page should look clean, and the spacing should be consistent.

2. CORRECT SPELLING/GRAMMAR

Check, check, check your spelling. Have someone proofread your résumé to spot mistakes before submitting.

3. PROFESSIONAL ATTITUDE

Use an e-mail address that sounds professional. Your full address needs to be clear. The phone number you use needs to have voicemail with a professional greeting message.

4. OBJECTIVE KEYWORDS

Your keywords should not be subjective like "reliable" or "hard-working". To an employer, the fact that you are reliable is not going to get you an interview. They are looking for problem solvers.

5. KEYWORDS FROM THE JOB DESCRIPTION

Choose words from the job description to enhance your résumé and get the prospective employer's attention.

6. RELEVANT JOB/INTERNSHIP/VOLUNTEER HISTORY

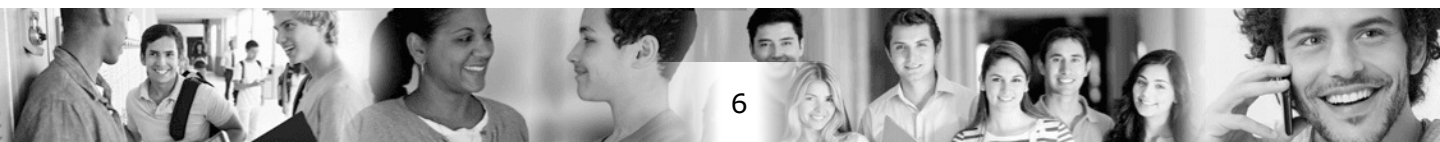
Your employment need only go back 10 to 15 years. Recent graduates should cite any part-time jobs they have had.

7. EFFECTIVE USE OF SPACE

Every word needs to count. White space makes your résumé look clean and uncluttered.

Examples:

- *A résumé is a document that summarizes your skill sets, experience and*





Learning Points

accomplishments.

- *It can show how you fit into your target industry.*
- *The potential employer wants to know what value you will bring to the company.*
- *So you need to make it clear right off the bat how you can add value.*
- *Your résumé is often the first point of contact and it needs to be easy to read.*

